Spark + Ember | Teacher Guide

October 19–23, 2026 · Week 3

October 19–23, 2026. Morning Meeting lessons run Monday–Thursday; Spark and Ember include Friday’s Wonder and close. Friday uses the school’s Cypher plan. Verify any local calendar exception before using a dated Friday board; the public school calendar currently linked by the school is for 2025–26, so it is not used to assert 2026 closure dates.

Arrival: greet at 7:15; independent 3–5 minute Spark; K–2 read, grades 3–8 IXL. Stop around 7:37 for announcements. Reveal afterward in two minutes or less. Morning Meeting begins 7:45. In the 2–3 band, grade 2 reads and grade 3 uses IXL.

Presentation: day keys 1–5; arrows Do Now → Reveal → Handoff; English/Spanish read aloud; repeat aloud for staggered arrivals; full screen; whole-week preview. Wednesday uses one complete object, cropped before reveal and slowly zoomed out afterward. Thursday tallies choices; the explanation matters more than the vote.

IXL: fixed Week 8, following the existing August 31 week-one rule. Codes come from the current data snapshot; no missing code is invented. Materials and codes stay readable in the existing upper-right IXL panel.

Ember: 2:05 seated pack-up → 2:08 watch/settle → 2:13 reflect → seated waiting. Use the first 90 seconds of the selected professionally produced clip, then quiet breathing. Keep all activity seated. A video model is a prompt, not proof of any student’s feelings. Existing offline breathing fallback remains. Walkers called at 2:10 may give a brief private response before leaving; do not hold them for a later slip.

Release: inherited order remains walkers 2:10; car/aftercare and activities 2:15; buses K–2 2:17, 3–5 2:20, 6–8 2:23. Adult call controls release. No lining up. Closed Chromebook stays on desk until called, then goes into the numbered charging slot before departure.

Access: draw, point, dictate, write, or pass. Read aloud if a device voice is unavailable. Eyes may stay open; students may breathe normally or observe quietly. Monday check-in is private. Review support requests promptly.

Picture answer key: six red triangles, four blue squares, three green circles; thirteen total; red fraction six thirteenths; blue-to-green ratio four-to-three. One open chair is visible. Feelings and intentions cannot be established from the image.

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Thursday key: K–1: ten blocks either way. 2–3: 3 × 4 = 4 × 3 = 12. 4–5: equal six-six-six; a different allocation needs a stated need. 6–8: 2 bridges + 3 towers uses 24; 1 bridge + 4 towers uses 22 with 2 left. Clarify whether leftovers are permitted.

Friday key: compare identical sheets over equal gaps and add identical loads. Change only folding. Count or record sag under the same load; repeat trials. A fair test can challenge the prediction. No student must build during independent arrival; use the pictured test and teacher demonstration at reveal.

Freshness: new prompts, maker-table scene, mystery objects, choice problems, paper-bridge investigation, and video selections. Recurring formats and procedures intentionally repeat. Media titles and publishers are checked against official provider metadata and the archived video inventory.

Sources: current Morning Meeting repository and AGENTS.md; existing Spark/Ember Week 2 decks; current IXL source https://marlithaw.github.io/Matchbook_Learning_IXL/ixl-data.json; provider links in the daily video table. Clip titles are credited to their creators; clips are linked rather than redistributed.